

Oppo Find X7 Ultra

Oppo's opulent optics

It is not everyday that we get to try out exclusive tech that probably won't even make it to the Indian market. The Oppo Find X7 Ultra is the latest of such smartphones and I was one of the few lucky guys who got to experience the device, along with a visit to Oppo's headquarters and factory in Shenzhen, China.

The Oppo Find X7 Ultra is a camera smartphone and a very good one at that. This is not me, even in DXO Mark's Global Camera Rankings, the Oppo Find X7 Ultra takes the top spot among all the smartphones in the world. This itself has my attention and from the moment I saw DXO Mark's ratings, I was very excited to test the Oppo Find X7 Ultra's camera. So in this review, I will begin by talking about the camera itself.

[Note: This is the global variant of the device and is not available in India]

CAMERA

So the Oppo Find X7 Ultra has a quad camera setup with four 50-megapixel sensors. It is also the first smartphone in the world to come with a dual periscope lens, meaning we are getting two telephoto periscope lenses with the Oppo Find X7 Ultra. Now, while this is something that hasn't been done before, it still only unleashes a 6x optical zoom, as compared to the 10x optical zoom that we have seen in some other competitors like the Vivo X100 Pro or last year's Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra.

Not taking away from anything that this new zoom tech brings to the table. The 6x optical zoom is brilliant and there is literally no lack of detail in 6x zoom shots. Further, what impressed me more was the smartphone's 120x zoom. This is probably the best quality on 120x digital zoom that I have personally seen on any smartphone. Brilliant.

Coming to more normal stuff, the camera on the Oppo Find X7 Ultra is

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brilliant. Be it images from the primary shooter, or the ultra-wide angle shooter, or even the telephoto lens, the images are sharp, have a good dynamic range, and represent colours very nicely.

There is also little to no colour shift when switching from the primary shooter to the ultra-wide angle lens. Even the level of details remain consistent, but there is a slight difference since the wide-angle shooter isn't able to peek out as much detail as the primary shooter on the Oppo Find X7 Ultra.

In low light also, the Oppo Find X7 Ultra puts out brilliant photos. The only thing I felt while shooting in low light was that the shutter speed gets a bit too slow automatically and each time I need less light and a quick snap, I have to turn off the low light mode on the Oppo Find X7 Ultra.

Same is the case while using the telephoto on the Oppo Find X7 Ultra. While the shutter speed is quick and the smartphone doesn't take any time to close the camera shutter, the processing is not

able to match up. Almost always while using the telephoto, the final processed photo is that of the next frame, and not the one that you captured, which makes it a bit tricky to capture moving objects.

Then there are portraits and here also, the results are as good as on any other smartphone, maybe better than some. Yes, we don't get as much to play around with as compared to the Vivo X100 Pro, but then again, no one would complain as long as the shots look straight out of a DSLR or mirrorless camera. The background blur is exceptional. It looks natural and singles out even the minutest details while focusing on the subject. Very good.

The skin tones from the photos in the Oppo Find X7 Ultra also feel very natural. Yes, there isn't as much tuning for Indian skin tones as much Vivo puts an effort, but as far as things are coming out to be natural, even in zoomed in shots, it is fine.

One thing I wish Oppo did better here is the collaboration with Hasselblad. I believe the Oppo's partnership with Hasselblad doesn't bring as much of "Hasselblad" into the cameras as some of the other ongoing collaborations that smartphone brands have with legacy camera makers. While the camera tuning has obviously been a team effort between Oppo and Hasselblad, the "Hasselblad" experience is limited to just the X-Pan mode, the three preset filters and the master mode, which is also the latest feature on Oppo and OnePlus smartphones.

DESIGN

Now, coming to the design, this by the looks of it, is a camera smartphone. The massive camera bump that takes over the whole top part of the smartphone leaves nothing to guess that this is, indeed a device that is focused on the camera. Add to that the prominent "Hasselblad" branding within the camera module, and the Oppo Find X7 Ultra, from the first glance, establishes itself as a camera-centric smartphone.

I got the blue and white colour option for my review and without any bias, this is my favourite out of the three colours that Oppo has launched the Oppo Find X7 Ultra in (not in India). The smartphone